The Fourth Sheet

Your accountant gives you three sheets. I give you the fourth.

SAMPLE DATA · invented figures for demonstration

Sample Electrical & Air Pty Ltd

An electrical and air-conditioning contractor in Brisbane: maintenance contracts, installations and call-outs. 7 technicians, 3 office staff.

How final is this data?

September 2026 Locked September 2026 is locked (closed 2 Oct 2026). These numbers won't change.

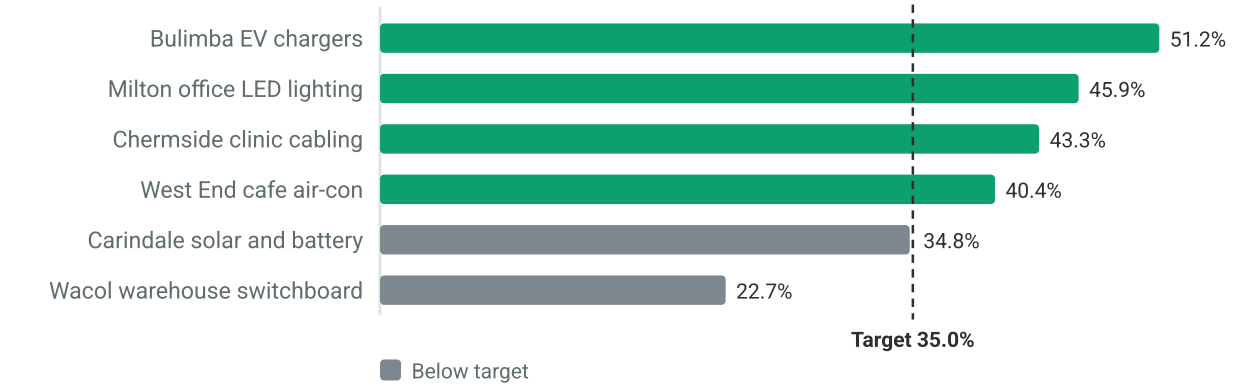
The fourth sheet: September 2026 vs August 2026

Gross margin (P&L), September	Cost to win a customer	Technician time on jobs
30.1%	**$162**	**64.3%**
▼ from 33.2% in Aug	▼ from $205 in Aug	▲ from 61.6% in Aug

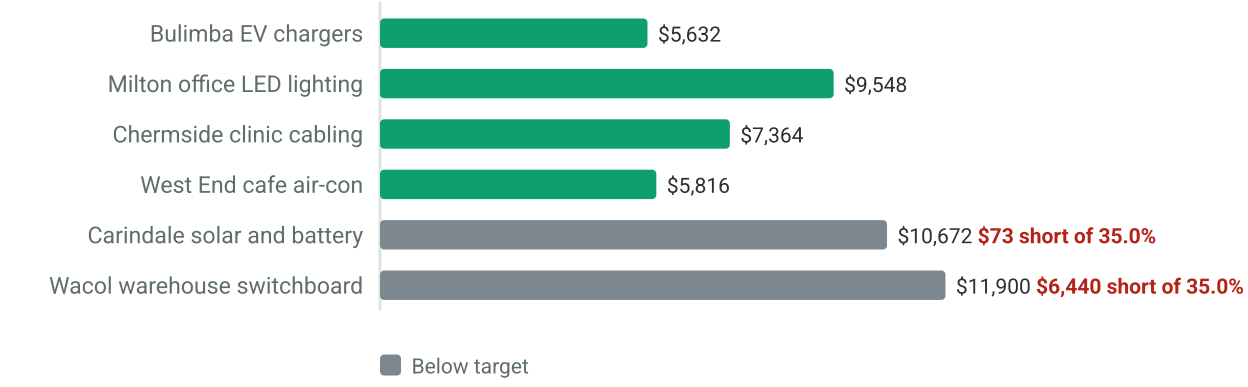
Job gross margin on each installation invoiced in September 2026

Whole job, recognised when invoiced: revenue less materials, subcontractors and technician time at $68/hour. Before overheads: not profit. One 35.0% target for every job for now.

Gross margin %



Gross margin $



How each number is worked out

Gross margin (P&L)

Gross profit ÷ revenue. All technician wages and on-costs included; overheads are not.

	Sep 2026	Aug 2026
Revenue (every job invoiced in the month)	$225,460	$199,523
Materials	($64,860)	($51,530)
Subcontractors	($13,200)	($9,300)
Technician wages	($79,587)	($72,352)
Gross profit	$67,813	$66,341
Gross margin (P&L)	**30.1%**	**33.2%**

Gross margin is before overheads (office wages, marketing, vehicles, rent and so on): it is not profit. Wages include their on-costs: super (12%) and leave as it's earned. No payroll tax: wages are under Queensland's $1.3 million threshold. Technicians are on salary, so a quiet month for jobs lowers gross margin even if every job is priced well.

Cost to win a customer

Marketing spend ÷ new customers

	Sep 2026	Aug 2026
Marketing spend	$7,600	$8,400
New customers (first job ever)	47	41
Cost per new customer	**$162**	**$205**

Technician time on jobs

Hours charged to jobs ÷ hours available

	Sep 2026	Aug 2026
Hours charged to jobs (timesheets)	752.5 h	655.0 h
Technicians	7	7
Working days	22	20
Hours per day	7.6 h	7.6 h
Hours available	1,170.4 h	1,064.0 h
Time on jobs	**64.3%**	**61.6%**

August had 20 working days: 21 weekdays, less the Ekka People's Day holiday (Wed 12 Aug). The rest is travel, training, quoting and waiting time.

Jobs, September 2026

Job	Type	Revenue	Materials	Subcontractors	Labour cost (incl. on-costs)	Job gross margin	Job gross margin %
Bulimba EV chargers	Installation	11,000	3,600	-	1,768	5,632	51.2
Carindale solar and battery	Installation	30,700	13,800	3,100	3,128	10,672	34.8
Chermside clinic cabling	Installation	17,000	4,300	1,800	3,536	7,364	43.3
Milton office LED lighting	Installation	20,800	6,900	-	4,352	9,548	45.9
Wacol warehouse switchboard	Installation	52,400	22,900	7,400	10,200	11,900	22.7
West End cafe air-con	Installation	14,400	5,100	900	2,584	5,816	40.4
Ashgrove aged care	Maintenance contract	4,050	80	-	1,360	2,610	64.4
Bulimba school	Maintenance contract	3,150	60	-	1,088	2,002	63.6
Carindale vet clinic	Maintenance contract	1,900	30	-	612	1,258	66.2
Chermside retail centre	Maintenance contract	4,600	100	-	1,564	2,936	63.8
Fortitude Valley hotel	Maintenance contract	3,800	70	-	1,292	2,438	64.2
Kangaroo Point townhouses	Maintenance contract	2,700	50	-	952	1,698	62.9
Milton office tower	Maintenance contract	4,700	90	-	1,632	2,978	63.4
Newstead gym	Maintenance contract	1,800	30	-	612	1,158	64.3
Riverside Apartments (strata)	Maintenance contract	3,600	60	-	1,224	2,316	64.3
Rocklea factory	Maintenance contract	4,350	110	-	1,496	2,744	63.1
Southbank cafe group	Maintenance contract	2,000	40	-	680	1,280	64.0
Wacol logistics depot	Maintenance contract	3,350	70	-	1,156	2,124	63.4
West End brewery	Maintenance contract	2,900	50	-	1,020	1,830	63.1
Wynnum medical centre	Maintenance contract	2,450	40	-	816	1,594	65.1
64 call-outs (each one is in the spreadsheet)	Call-out	33,810	7,380	-	10,098	16,332	48.3

Profit and loss, September 2026

Sep 2026: locked

$	Sep 2026	Aug 2026	Change
Revenue			
Maintenance contracts (14)	45,350	45,350	-
Installations (jobs)	146,300	122,800	23,500
Call-outs: technician time	24,216	22,338	1,878
Call-outs: materials charged	9,594	9,035	559
Total revenue	**225,460**	**199,523**	**25,937**
Cost of sales			
Materials	(64,860)	(51,530)	(13,330)
Subcontractors	(13,200)	(9,300)	(3,900)
Technician wages (incl. on-costs)	(79,587)	(72,352)	(7,235)
Total cost of sales	**(157,647)**	**(133,182)**	**(24,465)**
Gross profit	**67,813**	**66,341**	**1,472**
Operating expenses			
Office and admin wages	(21,900)	(21,900)	-
Marketing	(7,600)	(8,400)	800
Vehicles and fuel	(8,300)	(7,900)	(400)
Rent and occupancy	(7,000)	(7,000)	-
Insurance	(3,000)	(3,000)	-
IT and software	(2,300)	(2,300)	-
Other overheads	(3,900)	(3,600)	(300)
Total operating expenses	**(54,000)**	**(54,100)**	**100**
EBITDA	**13,813**	**12,241**	**1,572**
Depreciation	**(4,500)**	**(4,300)**	**(200)**
Interest	**(1,080)**	**(1,100)**	**20**
Profit before tax	**8,233**	**6,841**	**1,392**
Income tax provision (25%)	**(2,058)**	**(1,710)**	**(348)**
Net profit after tax	**6,175**	**5,131**	**1,044**

Balance sheet at 30 September 2026

Sep 2026: locked

$	Sep 2026	Aug 2026	Change
Current assets			
Cash at bank	120,228	92,859	27,369
Trade debtors (unpaid invoices)	185,678	159,756	25,922
Materials on hand	66,000	66,000	-
Prepayments	21,000	21,000	-
Total current assets	**392,906**	**339,615**	**53,291**
Vehicles and equipment	**255,200**	**247,700**	**7,500**
Total assets	**648,106**	**587,315**	**60,791**
Current liabilities			
Trade creditors (bills due next month)	85,866	66,913	18,953
Wages owed (since the last pay run)	37,678	27,458	10,220
Super payable	4,523	3,296	1,227
PAYG withholding payable	47,754	31,836	15,918
GST payable (net)	32,817	22,477	10,340
Employee leave provisions	106,000	105,100	900
Income tax payable	35,268	33,210	2,058
Total current liabilities	**349,906**	**290,290**	**59,616**
Equity finance	**95,000**	**100,000**	**(5,000)**
Total liabilities	**444,906**	**390,290**	**54,616**
Net assets	**203,200**	**197,025**	**6,175**
Equity			
Share capital	10,000	10,000	-
Retained earnings	193,200	187,025	6,175
Total equity	**203,200**	**197,025**	**6,175**

Cash flow, September 2026

Sep 2026: locked

$	Sep 2026	Aug 2026	Change
Operating activities			
Receipts from customers (invoices paid)	222,094	191,442	30,652
Payments to suppliers	(102,223)	(107,261)	5,038
Payments to employees	(73,222)	(73,222)	-
Interest paid	(1,080)	(1,100)	20
GST, PAYG and income tax paid (BAS)	-	-	-
Net cash from operating activities	**45,569**	**9,859**	**35,710**
Investing activities			
Purchase of vehicles and equipment	(13,200)	-	(13,200)
Net cash from investing activities	**(13,200)**	**-**	**(13,200)**
Financing activities			
Equipment finance repaid	(5,000)	(5,000)	-
Net cash from financing activities	**(5,000)**	**(5,000)**	**-**
Net change in cash	**27,369**	**4,859**	**22,510**
Cash at start of month	**92,859**	**88,000**	**4,859**
Cash at end of month	**120,228**	**92,859**	**27,369**

Assumptions

The business

What it is	An electrical and air-conditioning contractor in Brisbane: maintenance contracts, installations and call-outs. 7 technicians, 3 office staff.
Reporting month	September 2026 (the last closed month), compared with August 2026
Financial year	FY2027: 1 July 2026 to 30 June 2027

Jobs (September)

Maintenance contracts	14 customers, invoiced on the 1st, paid in about 30 days
Installations	6 named jobs, each with its own quote, materials, subcontractors and hours
Call-outs	64 jobs at $163/hour plus materials marked up 30%
Jobs in September	84 in total (every one is in the spreadsheet download and CSV)

Costs

Technicians	7 employed full time: $79,587 in September incl. on-costs (every available hour at $68)
Job costing rate	$68/hour = technician wages incl. on-costs ÷ available hours, worked out each month; time charged to jobs + time not charged = technician wages
Working days	20 in August (21 weekdays, less the Ekka People's Day holiday, Wed 12 Aug), 22 in September; 7.6 hours a day
Overheads	set month by month, as shown in the P&L
Income tax	25% of profit, provided monthly; the PAYG instalment is paid with each quarter's BAS

Cash and balance sheet

Customer payments	each invoice is paid on its own date; unpaid invoices at month end = debtors
Supplier bills	materials and subcontractors are paid the following month
Equipment finance	$5,000 repaid each month
New equipment	a $12,000 trailer bought in September

GST, BAS and payroll

GST	registered; 10%, accruals basis: GST on a sale is owed when it's invoiced, a credit on a bill is claimed when it's received. The P&L excludes GST; invoices, bills, debtors, creditors and cash include it
BAS	quarterly, self-lodged: GST on sales − GST credits + PAYG withheld + PAYG instalment. July to September is due 28 October; October to December, 28 February
Pay runs	fortnightly on Thursdays: $39,795 gross (a 26th of the year's gross wages); net pay $31,836 and super $4,775 paid on the day; PAYG withheld (about 20% of gross, $7,959) goes with the BAS. Two months a year have three pay runs
Super	12% of gross wages, paid with each pay run (Payday Super, from 1 July 2026)
Payroll tax	none: Queensland's threshold is $1.3 million of wages a year (rate 4.75% above it); this business pays about $1,159,000 including super
Banking days	money only moves on banking days: a payment due on a weekend or Queensland public holiday moves to the next banking day

Checks (all passed)

- ✓ Every subtotal and total adds up
- ✓ Balance sheet balances: assets = liabilities + equity
- ✓ Cash flow ends at the cash in the bank
- ✓ Profit ties to the movement in retained earnings
- ✓ Every job's revenue, materials and subcontractors add up to the P&L
- ✓ Trade debtors equal the invoices still unpaid at month end

Generated 28 Oct 2026, 12:45pm by a driver-based model: every figure is calculated from the assumptions above. Sample data only, not financial advice. Made with Python: laid out in HTML and CSS, printed to PDF in Chromium.